Mini Project: Simple Navigation Bar

HTML & CSS Course, Beginner Project

Your Mission

Build a horizontal navigation bar like the menu at the top of a real website. It will have four links in a row, a colored background, and a hover effect.

HTML Requirements

Your page must include all of the following:

- The basic HTML skeleton (`<html>` , `<head>` , `<body>`) and a page `<title>`
- **A `<nav>` element** that wraps your menu
- **An unordered list** (`<ul>`) inside the `<nav>`
- **Four list items** (`<li>`), each with a link (`<a>`): Home, About, Hobbies, and Contact
- **A heading** (`<h1>`) and **one short paragraph** (`<p>`) below the menu, so the page has some content

The links can point to `#` for now, since you only need the menu to look right.

CSS Requirements

Your CSS must be in a separate file called `style.css` and linked from your HTML page. It must include all of the following:

- A **background color** for the navigation bar
- **Removed bullet points** from the list (`list-style: none`)
- **Removed default spacing** from the list (`margin: 0` and `padding: 0`)
- List items placed **side by side** (use `display: inline-block`)
- **Padding** on each link so the menu items are easy to click
- **Removed underlines** from the links (`text-decoration: none`)
- A readable **text color** for the links
- A **hover effect** that changes the link's background color (`a:hover`)

File Setup

1. Create a folder called `navbar`.
2. Inside it, create two files: `index.html` and `style.css`.

Checklist

Tick each box when you are done.

- [ ] My menu is inside a `<nav>` with a `<ul>` and four links
- [ ] My bullet points are gone
- [ ] My links are in one row, not stacked
- [ ] My navigation bar has a background color
- [ ] My links change color when I hover over them
- [ ] My CSS file is linked and my page has color
- [ ] I tested my page by refreshing it in the browser

Bonus Challenges (If You Finish Early)

1. **Active page:** Give the "Home" link a different color to show it is the current page.
2. **Rounded hover:** Add `border-radius` to the links so the hover effect has rounded corners.
3. **Centered menu:** Center the menu using `text-align: center`.
4. **New font:** Choose a font from Google Fonts for your menu.
5. **Right-aligned link:** Make the "Contact" link sit at the far right of the bar.

Stuck? Try This

- **My links are stacked on top of each other:** Check that `display: inline-block` is applied to the `<li>` elements.
- **There is a gap above my menu:** The list has default margin. Set `margin: 0` on the `<ul>` and on the `<body>`.
- **My hover color is not showing:** Make sure the rule is written as `a:hover` and that it comes after your normal link styles.
- **Nothing changed:** Save both files, then refresh the browser.

Show Off Your Work

When you are finished, show your menu to a classmate and ask them to click each link. Have fun!